

UTTARAKHAND
ASCENDS AS A PREMIER HUB IN AYUSH AND HOLISTIC WELLNESS

India has a rich cultural precedence of age-old medicinal treatment methods, which include Ayurveda, Yoga, Unani, Siddha, and Homeopathy (AYUSH). Uttarakhand, in particular, stands out as a bastion of these traditional practices. AYUSH has remained a core part of the culture and tradition of Uttarakhand for years. Aligned with Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi's vision, Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami is spearheading efforts to position Uttarakhand as a frontrunner across all domains nationwide. At the heart of this mission lies the resolute commitment of the Dhami government to ensure the accessibility of AYUSH treatments to the people of Uttarakhand. Uttarakhand is swiftly emerging as a beacon for AYUSH medicine, fostering an environment conducive to research and innovation. This journey encompasses the establishment of hospitals and wellness centers, the cultivation and promotion of herbal resources, the certification of AYUSH services, and the comprehensive training of AYUSH practitioners and pharmacists.

The Uttarakhand government is steadfastly advancing its efforts to promote AYUSH. With its rich natural and cultural heritage, Uttarakhand emerges as an ideal destination to establish itself as a beacon of AYUSH practices. Boasting an abundance of rare herbs, favorable locations, and conducive environments for AYUSH treatments, the state holds immense potential in this domain. To enhance Uttarakhand's global standing as the "Dev Bhoomi," the Dhami administration took a significant stride by approving the state's first AYUSH policy during a cabinet meeting on September 01, 2023, three months prior to the December 2023 "Global Investors Summit". This visionary policy sets a commendable target: to extend AYUSH services to every individual in the state within the next five years.

In alignment with this goal, the AYUSH policy delineates five key pillars for the AYUSH ecosystem in the state: cultivation of medicinal plants, AYUSH manufacturing (medicines and consumer products), healthcare services, wellness, education, and research. The overarching objective is to attract investment and foster private sector engagement in these domains while enhancing the quality of AYUSH services offered.

Uttarakhand has emerged as a robust manufacturing hub for pharmaceutical drugs, strategically located near major markets like Delhi NCR, Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, and Haryana. The availability of affordable electricity and water, ease of doing business, and favorable government policies and incentives have led to the establishment of several AYUSH production units in the state. Some of the largest AYUSH manufacturers in the country have set up operations in Uttarakhand, producing AYUSH medicines and consumer products adhering to the rigorous standards of Good Manufacturing Practices (GMP). Presently, the state boasts 232 GMP-certified Ayurveda, 8 Homeopathy, and 2 Unani manufacturing units. This includes both public sector entities such as the Indian Medical Pharmaceutical Corporation Limited (IMPCL) and the Rishikul State Ayurvedic Pharmacy. The AYUSH manufacturing sector in Uttarakhand contributes significantly to the state's GDP, estimated to range between Rs 4,000-5,000 crore. Furthermore, this sector serves as a vital source of employment, providing livelihoods to approximately 20,000-25,000 individuals across the state.

Due to its deep-rooted historical, spiritual, and cultural significance, AYUSH has gained widespread acceptance as a treatment method on par with allopathy in Uttarakhand. The state hosts